

UPSELL 4

# Scale Your Studio™

Three paths to grow your craft business beyond your own two hands.

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**Table Patterns**

# Table of Contents

|                                               |           |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Section 1 — The Studio Scale Blueprint</b> | <b>4</b>  |
| Path Assessment Quiz                          | 5         |
| The Revenue Ceiling Calculator                | 7         |
| Choosing Your Path (or Combining)             | 10        |
| <b>Section 2 — Helper Training Checklist</b>  | <b>14</b> |
| Finding Your Helper                           | 15        |
| The Weekend Training Program                  | 17        |
| Quality Control System                        | 22        |
| <b>Section 3 — Craft Kit Assembly Guide</b>   | <b>24</b> |
| What Goes in a Kit                            | 25        |
| Pricing Your Kits                             | 27        |
| Packaging and Presentation                    | 29        |
| Selling and Shipping Kits                     | 32        |
| <b>Section 4 — Workshop-in-a-Box</b>          | <b>35</b> |
| Your Workshop Format                          | 36        |
| The Workshop Script                           | 38        |
| Supply List and Costs                         | 42        |



## SECTION 1

# The Studio Scale Blueprint

Three proven paths to move from solo maker to a real production studio — choose one, then add another when you're ready.

*Every handmade table setting business hits the same wall: you can only cut, weave, knot, and finish so many pieces per week. Your hands have a hard limit. This section shows you three ways past that wall — each one tested by real craft sellers — so you can pick the path that fits your life right now.*



*A dedicated studio space sets the foundation for scaling your craft business.*

Before we dig into the specifics, here is the truth about scaling a craft business: **the goal is not to become a factory**. The goal is to earn more per hour of your time without sacrificing the quality that earned your reputation. Each of the three paths in this Blueprint does that differently:

- **Hiring a Helper** multiplies your production hands while you keep creative control.
- **Craft Kits** let you sell your expertise without doing every stitch yourself.
- **Teaching Workshops** turn your skill into a per-hour service that pays more than any single piece.

None of these paths requires you to quit making finished pieces. In fact, most successful craft sellers eventually run two or three paths at once: finished pieces for their premium buyers, kits for the DIY crowd, and an occasional workshop for extra visibility and cash flow.

## Path Assessment Quiz

Answer these five questions honestly. They will point you toward the path that matches your current situation — not the one that sounds most exciting, but the one you can start this week.

### Question 1: How much free workspace do you have?

- **A.** Enough for another person to sit and work comfortably alongside me.
- **B.** I have a table or counter where I could stage and pack kits, but not room for two people crafting at once.
- **C.** Very little — my workspace is my dining table and I clear it between sessions.

### Question 2: What is more draining to you?

- **A.** Doing the same repetitive steps over and over — I would rather someone else handled the simpler pieces.
- **B.** Keeping track of orders and production — I wish I could just package things up in bulk and ship.
- **C.** Working alone — I actually enjoy being around other people while I craft.

### Question 3: What sounds most realistic in the next 30 days?

- **A.** Finding someone local who is interested in learning my craft.
- **B.** Buying materials in slightly larger quantities and pre-cutting fabric for 10–15 kits.
- **C.** Calling a community center or library to ask about hosting a craft event.

### Question 4: How do you feel about pricing?

- **A.** I am comfortable selling finished pieces and just want more of them to sell.
- **B.** I would be happy to sell something at a lower price point if I could move a lot more units.
- **C.** I would rather charge a premium for my time and expertise than sell physical products.

### Question 5: What is your biggest constraint?

- **A.** Time — I have more orders than I can fill.
- **B.** Reach — I need to get in front of more people without spending every weekend at a craft fair.
- **C.** Cash flow — I need a way to bring in money faster while I build my product inventory.

### Scoring

**Mostly A:** Start with Path 1 — Hiring a Helper. You have the space, the demand, and the desire to delegate production work.

**Mostly B:** Start with Path 2 — Craft Kits. You are ready to shift from piece-by-piece production to a more scalable product format.

**Mostly C:** Start with Path 3 — Teaching Workshops. Your social energy and expertise are your biggest assets right now.

## The Three Paths at a Glance

| PATH                           | BEST FOR                                                                                | STARTUP COST | TIME TO FIRST REVENUE | DIFFICULTY  |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------|-------------|
| <b>Path 1: Hiring a Helper</b> | Makers who have more orders than hands and want to keep selling finished pieces         | \$0 – \$200  | 2 – 4 weeks           | Medium      |
| <b>Path 2: Craft Kits</b>      | Makers who want to sell to DIY crafters at a lower price point with less per-unit labor | \$50 – \$150 | 1 – 2 weeks           | Easy        |
| <b>Path 3: Workshops</b>       | Makers who enjoy teaching, want faster cash flow, and like working with people          | \$0 – \$100  | 2 – 6 weeks           | Medium–Hard |



*Knowing your numbers is the first step toward breaking through your revenue ceiling.*

## The Revenue Ceiling Calculator

*Before you choose a path, you need to know exactly where your ceiling is right now. This calculator shows you the math behind your current limit — and how each path raises it.*

### Step 1: Find Your Current Weekly Revenue

Fill in these numbers based on a typical week:

| VARIABLE                        | YOUR NUMBER | EXAMPLE  |
|---------------------------------|-------------|----------|
| Pieces you finish per week      | _____       | 4 pieces |
| Average selling price per piece | \$_____     | \$45     |
| Weekly revenue (pieces × price) | \$_____     | \$180    |

### Step 2: Find Your Hard Ceiling

| VARIABLE                                        | YOUR NUMBER | EXAMPLE  |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------|
| Maximum hours you can work per week on crafting | _____       | 20 hours |

| VARIABLE                                         | YOUR NUMBER | EXAMPLE    |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------|
| Average hours to complete one piece              | _____       | 4.5 hours  |
| Maximum pieces per week (hours ÷ time per piece) | _____       | 4.4 pieces |
| Maximum weekly revenue (max pieces × price)      | \$_____     | \$198      |

### The gap that matters

If your current revenue is already close to your maximum, you have hit the ceiling. The only way to grow is to change the equation — more hands, different products, or selling your time differently.

## Step 3: See How Each Path Changes the Math

| PATH       | WHAT CHANGES                                                                                                                       | EXAMPLE IMPACT (ON OUR \$180/WEEK MAKER)                                                                                                                                        |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Helper     | Double production hours. Helper handles simpler pieces; you focus on complex, higher-priced ones.                                  | Helper makes 3 simple pieces at \$35 each = \$105. You make 4 complex pieces at \$55 each = \$220. <b>New weekly total: \$325.</b> Minus helper pay (~\$60) = <b>\$265 net.</b> |
| Craft Kits | Each kit takes 15–20 minutes to assemble instead of 4+ hours to craft a finished piece.                                            | You assemble 12 kits in 4 hours at \$22 each = \$264. You still make 3 finished pieces = \$135. <b>New weekly total: \$399.</b> Minus kit materials (~\$72) = <b>\$327 net.</b> |
| Workshops  | Your hourly rate jumps. A 2-hour workshop with 8 participants at \$45 each = \$360 for 2 hours of teaching plus 2–3 hours of prep. | One workshop per week = \$360. Minus materials for 8 students (~\$64) = \$296. Plus your regular 4 pieces = \$180. <b>New weekly total: \$476 net.</b>                          |

### Key takeaway

Every path can raise your weekly take-home by 50% or more. The right choice depends on your situation, not on which one earns the most on paper. A helper requires the least change to what you are already doing. Kits are the fastest to launch. Workshops have the highest per-hour rate but require a different skill set.

## Choosing Your Path (or Combining)

*Most sellers eventually run more than one path. Here is how to decide what to start with and when to layer on the next one.*

## Decision Framework

**Start with one path.** Give it at least 4–6 weeks of real effort before adding a second. Here is how to choose:

### CHOOSE A HELPER FIRST IF...

- You have a waiting list or regularly turn down orders.
- Your patterns include a range of difficulty levels, and someone else could handle the simpler ones.
- You know someone who might be interested (a crafty friend, a family member, a neighbor).
- You have workspace for two people.

### CHOOSE CRAFT KITS FIRST IF...

- You want to test a new revenue stream with minimal risk.
- You already buy materials in bulk and have extras.
- Your audience includes people who have said "I wish I could make that" or "How do you do that?"
- You sell online and want a product that ships easily and cheaply.

### CHOOSE WORKSHOPS FIRST IF...

- You enjoy teaching and do well in social settings.
- You live in an area with community centers, libraries, or craft stores that host events.
- You need cash flow now — workshops pay upfront, before the event.
- You want to build a local reputation and customer base.

## The Best Combinations

### Helper + Kits

**How it works:** Your helper produces finished pieces while you spend some of your freed-up time assembling kits. You sell both products through the same channels.

**Why it works:** Kit assembly is easy to do in short bursts between other tasks. Your helper keeps the finished-piece pipeline running so you never lose that revenue stream.

**When to combine:** After your helper can reliably produce 3–5 pieces per week without constant supervision (usually 4–6 weeks in).

### Workshops + Kits

**How it works:** At the end of every workshop, offer take-home kits for participants to make their next piece at home. Workshop attendees are pre-qualified kit buyers — they already know they enjoy the craft and they trust your instruction.

**Why it works:** Conversion rates from workshop to kit purchase are very high because the participant just experienced the satisfaction of making something with their hands.

**When to combine:** From your very first workshop. Have kits ready on the table before participants arrive.

## Helper + Workshops

**How it works:** Your helper handles production while you host workshops. The workshops generate new customers who then buy your helper-made finished pieces.

**Why it works:** Workshop participants who are not the DIY type become your best finished-piece customers. They have seen your skill firsthand and they value what goes into each piece.

**When to combine:** After your helper is established and producing consistently. You need confidence that orders will be fulfilled while you are out teaching.

## All Three Together

**How it works:** You teach 1–2 workshops per month, your helper produces finished pieces to order, and you assemble kits during your off hours. Your customer gets three ways to buy from you: finished (premium), kit (mid-range), or workshop (experience).

**Why it works:** You capture every type of buyer. The person who cannot afford a \$65 runner can buy a \$22 kit. The person who wants the experience pays \$45 for a workshop. The person who wants it done pays full price for a finished piece.

**When to combine:** 3–6 months after your first path is running smoothly.

## The order that works best for most makers

**Month 1–2:** Launch craft kits (lowest risk, fastest start).

**Month 2–4:** Book and deliver your first workshop (sell kits at the event).

**Month 4–6:** Bring on a helper to handle finished-piece production (you now have three revenue streams).

This is not the only order, but it is the most forgiving one. Each step builds naturally on the last.

## SECTION 2

# Helper Training Checklist

A complete program for finding, training, and managing a production helper — from first conversation to first quality piece.

*Bringing in a helper is the most direct way to double your output without changing what you sell. But “just find someone to help” is not a plan. This section is the plan: where to find the right person, how to train them over a single weekend, and how to keep quality consistent from the very first piece they make on their own.*



*Teaching your helper one-on-one at the craft table builds confidence and consistency from day one.*

## Finding Your Helper

### Where to Look

The best helpers are not necessarily professional crafters. They are people who are patient, detail-oriented, and enjoy repetitive handwork. Here are the most productive places to find them:

- 1 Local craft and fiber arts groups.** Search for knitting circles, quilting guilds, macrame meetups, or sewing groups in your area. Members already have hand skills and understand materials. Post a short message: "I make table runners and placemats from cord and fabric. Looking for someone who would like to learn my technique and help me fill orders. Paid per piece. No experience with my specific craft needed — I will teach you everything."
- 2 Community bulletin boards.** Libraries, community centers, churches, and co-ops often have physical bulletin boards. A printed card works better than a digital post for reaching retirees and stay-at-home parents — two of the best pools of potential helpers.
- 3 Retirement communities and senior centers.** Retirees often have excellent hand skills, plenty of time, and appreciate the social aspect of learning something new. Many are looking for part-time income that they can do at home on their own schedule.
- 4 Local college or vocational school art/textile departments.** Students studying textiles, fashion, or art may welcome paid work that builds their portfolio. They tend to learn quickly and are comfortable following instructions precisely.
- 5 Word of mouth.** Tell your existing customers you are looking for a helper. Someone who already loves your products may know the perfect person — or may want the job themselves.

### Skills to Look For vs. Skills You Will Teach

| MUST ALREADY HAVE                                    | NICE TO HAVE (BUT NOT REQUIRED)        | YOU WILL TEACH                         |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Patience with repetitive tasks                       | Experience with cord, rope, or macrame | Your specific patterns and techniques  |
| Good hand-eye coordination                           | Sewing or fabric-cutting experience    | Your quality standards                 |
| Ability to follow written instructions               | Previous craft business experience     | Your finishing and packaging process   |
| Reliability (shows up when they say they will)       | Access to their own workspace          | Material handling and storage          |
| Willingness to redo work that does not meet standard | A personal interest in table decor     | The handoff and communication workflow |

### The Trial Piece

Before committing to a helper, ask them to complete a single trial piece under your supervision. This is not a test they pass or fail — it is a way for both of you to see whether the working relationship feels right. Pay them for their time regardless of the outcome.

## Trial Piece Evaluation

- ☐ Did they follow your pattern instructions without needing to be corrected more than 2–3 times?
- ☐ Did they ask questions when they were unsure, rather than guessing?
- ☐ Did the finished piece meet your quality standard (or come close enough that a little more practice would get them there)?
- ☐ Did they seem to enjoy the work, or were they visibly frustrated or bored?
- ☐ Were they on time and did they stay for the agreed duration?
- ☐ Would you want to spend another full day working alongside this person?

## Compensation Models

| MODEL                | HOW IT WORKS                                                                      | BEST WHEN                                                                                     | EXAMPLE RATE                                |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Per Piece</b>     | You pay a flat rate for each completed piece that passes quality check.           | Your helper works from home on their own schedule. You have consistent orders to fill.        | \$12–\$25 per piece depending on complexity |
| <b>Hourly</b>        | You pay for the hours worked, regardless of output.                               | Your helper is still learning and their speed varies. They work alongside you at your studio. | \$12–\$18/hour                              |
| <b>Revenue Share</b> | Your helper receives a percentage of the sale price for each piece they complete. | You want to share the risk. Best for experienced helpers who produce quality consistently.    | 25–35% of the piece's sale price            |

### Important note on compensation

Start with hourly pay during training, then switch to per-piece once your helper can work independently. Per-piece pay rewards speed and efficiency, but only after they have proven they can maintain quality at a reasonable pace. If you start with per-piece too early, the helper may rush and produce substandard work.

## The Weekend Training Program

*This is a complete two-day training program. After this weekend, your helper should be able to produce simple pieces independently with only a quality check from you at the*

end.



*Wall-mounted storage keeps every material visible and within reach during training sessions.*

## Before the Weekend: Prepare These Materials

### Pre-Training Preparation

- ☐ Print two copies of your 3 simplest patterns (large, clear text)
- ☐ Pre-cut fabric for 3 practice pieces
- ☐ Pre-measure cord/thread for 3 practice pieces
- ☐ Gather all tools your helper will use (scissors, ruler, pins, glue, etc.)
- ☐ Set up a second workstation with good lighting
- ☐ Prepare a finished example of each practice piece for reference
- ☐ Write out your quality checklist (Section 2c) and print 5 copies
- ☐ Have a notepad ready for your helper to take notes



*Hands-on demonstration is the fastest way to transfer your technique to a new helper.*

## Saturday Morning — Session 1: Foundations (3 hours)

### Session 1 Checklist

- ☐ **Materials Tour (30 min):** Walk through every material you use. Let your helper touch and handle each one. Explain the difference between materials that look similar (e.g., jute vs. sisal, cotton cord vs. poly cord). Show which ones fray, which ones stretch, which ones are forgiving.
- ☐ **Tool Orientation (15 min):** Demonstrate every tool. Show how you hold your scissors for straight cuts vs. curves. Show the correct ruler placement. Explain which pins to use and where.
- ☐ **Organization System (15 min):** Show how you store materials, where finished pieces go, how work-in-progress is organized. Your helper needs to maintain the same system so nothing gets lost or mixed up.
- ☐ **Pattern Reading (30 min):** Take your simplest pattern and walk through it line by line. Explain your shorthand, your numbering, any symbols. Have your helper read the next section of the pattern back to you to confirm understanding.
- ☐ **Basic Technique Demonstration (45 min):** Work through the first section of a simple piece while narrating every single thing you do. Slow way down. Explain the “why” behind each move: “I pull the cord this tight because if it is looser, the pattern shifts left on the next row.”
- ☐ **Helper Practice (45 min):** Have your helper repeat what you demonstrated. Watch silently for the first few minutes. Then offer corrections gently and specifically: “Try pulling the cord at a 45-degree angle instead of straight up — it keeps the tension more even.”

## Saturday Afternoon — Session 2: First Complete Piece (3 hours)

### Session 2 Checklist

- ☐ **Work Together on One Piece (90 min):** Sit side by side. You do one section, then your helper does the next section. Alternate throughout the piece. This lets them see your hand position, speed, and technique up close, and it gives you a chance to observe their work in real time.
- ☐ **Common Mistakes Review (30 min):** Show the 5 most common mistakes you have seen (or made yourself when learning). For each one, show what it looks like and how to fix it. If possible, show a flawed piece alongside a correct one.
- ☐ **Quality Standard Calibration (30 min):** Go through the finished piece together using your quality checklist. For each checkpoint, show what “passes” and what “needs work.” Be specific: “The edge should be within 2mm of straight. This one is about 4mm off — that needs to be redone.”
- ☐ **Speed and Quality Discussion (30 min):** Set clear expectations. A helper's first independent pieces will take longer than yours. That is normal. Give them a target time range: “This piece takes me 3 hours. For your first few, aim for 4–5 hours. As you practice, you will get closer to 3.”

## Sunday Morning — Session 3: Independent Work (3 hours)

### Session 3 Checklist

- ☐ **Independent Piece Start (full session):** Give your helper a pattern, materials, and the finished reference piece. Step back. Let them work. The goal is to see what happens when you are not guiding every step.
- ☐ **Observe Without Intervening:** Stay in the room but work on your own project. Only step in if they ask for help or if you see them about to make an irreversible mistake (cutting fabric wrong, for example).
- ☐ **Take Notes:** Write down what they struggle with, where they slow down, and what they get right. These notes will help you decide which patterns to assign them first.
- ☐ **Joint Review:** When the piece is done (or as close to done as possible), sit down together. Go through the quality checklist point by point. Be honest but kind. The goal is calibration, not judgment.
- ☐ **Calibration Conversation:** Ask your helper: “What felt hardest? Where did you feel uncertain? What would help you feel more confident?” Their answers will tell you what to include in the written instructions you leave with them.

## Sunday Afternoon — Session 4: Workflow Setup (2 hours)

### Session 4 Checklist

- ☐ **Second Piece Start (45 min):** Have your helper begin a second piece. This time, give even less guidance. You are testing whether they retained what they learned yesterday.
- ☐ **Handoff Protocol (30 min):** Establish how work moves between you. Decide: Will your helper pick up materials from you, or will you deliver? Where do they put finished pieces? How do they let you know something is done? Keep it simple: a text message that says “Two runners done, ready for pickup” is enough.
- ☐ **Pattern Assignment (15 min):** Go through your pattern catalog together. Mark each pattern as “helper-ready” (they can make it now), “helper-soon” (they can try it in 2–4 weeks), or “your-only” (too complex to delegate right now). Start them on 2–3 helper-ready patterns.
- ☐ **Schedule and Communication (30 min):** Agree on a regular schedule. How many pieces per week? Which days do they work? How do you communicate — text, phone call, in person? When do you check in on progress? Set a regular quality check (e.g., every Tuesday you review that week’s completed pieces).

## Quality Control System

*Your reputation depends on consistency. Every piece that goes to a customer — whether you made it or your helper did — must meet the same standard. This system makes that possible.*



*Every piece gets the same five-point inspection before it reaches a customer.*

## The 5-Point Quality Check

Check every piece against these five criteria. Each one gets a pass or needs-work rating. A piece must pass all five to ship.

| # | CHECKPOINT         | WHAT TO LOOK FOR                                                                                                                              | COMMON FAIL                                                                                |
|---|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Alignment</b>   | Pattern lines are straight and evenly spaced. Edges are parallel. No drifting left or right as the piece progresses.                          | Rows gradually shift to one side, making the piece look crooked when laid flat.            |
| 2 | <b>Tension</b>     | Cord or thread tension is consistent throughout. No loose spots, no overly tight spots that pucker the fabric.                                | The first few rows are too tight (nervous start) or the last rows are too loose (fatigue). |
| 3 | <b>Cleanliness</b> | No visible glue residue. No stray threads. No pencil or chalk marks remaining. No dirty fingerprints on light-colored materials.              | Glue blobs on the underside. Loose thread ends not trimmed.                                |
| 4 | <b>Dimensions</b>  | The finished piece matches the target dimensions within 1 cm. Measure length and width. For runners, check that both ends are the same width. | The piece is the right length but narrows by 1–2 cm on one end due to increasing tension.  |

| # | CHECKPOINT       | WHAT TO LOOK FOR                                                                                                            | COMMON FAIL                                                     |
|---|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5 | <b>Finishing</b> | Edges are clean and even. Fringe (if applicable) is cut straight. Backing is secure. Tags or labels are attached correctly. | Uneven fringe. Backing peeling at one corner. Tag sewn crooked. |

### When to Redo vs. When to Fix

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Fix It Yourself (Quick Repair)</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Minor tension variation in 1–2 rows</li><li>• A small glue spot that can be cleaned</li><li>• Fringe that needs trimming</li><li>• A loose thread end that needs tucking</li><li>• A tag that needs re-attaching</li></ul> <p><b>Rule of thumb:</b> If you can fix it in under 10 minutes without disassembling anything, fix it yourself.</p> | <p><b>Have Your Helper Redo It</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Alignment is off by more than 3mm</li><li>• Tension problems affect more than 3 rows</li><li>• Dimensions are more than 1 cm off target</li><li>• Pattern error (wrong count, skipped step)</li><li>• Fabric is stained or damaged</li></ul> <p><b>Rule of thumb:</b> If it affects the visual impression when the piece is laid on a table, it gets redone. Pay your helper for the redo.</p> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Pattern Progression: What to Assign First

| STAGE                       | TIMEFRAME     | PATTERN TYPES                                                              | YOUR INVOLVEMENT                                                                    |
|-----------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Stage 1: Learning</b>    | Weeks 1–2     | Simple placemats, basic single-color cord patterns, small centerpiece mats | Check every piece. Provide detailed feedback.                                       |
| <b>Stage 2: Building</b>    | Weeks 3–4     | Two-color patterns, medium-length runners, patterns with simple borders    | Check every piece. Feedback shifts to “this is ready” or “fix this one thing.”      |
| <b>Stage 3: Confident</b>   | Weeks 5–8     | Full-length runners, multi-color patterns, pieces with fringe or tassels   | Spot-check every third piece. Your helper self-reviews using the quality checklist. |
| <b>Stage 4: Independent</b> | Week 9 onward | Most of your catalog except your most complex signature pieces             | Weekly batch review. Focus on consistency across multiple pieces.                   |

## SECTION 3

# Craft Kit Assembly Guide

Turn your patterns into ready-to-make kits that sell for less than a finished piece but take a fraction of the time to prepare.

*A craft kit is your expertise in a bag. The customer gets the satisfaction of making something with their own hands; you get revenue from a product that takes 15–20 minutes to assemble instead of 4+ hours to craft. Here is exactly what goes into a kit, how to price it, how to package it, and how to sell it.*



*Setting up an assembly-line workflow lets you pack a batch of kits in a single session.*

## What Goes in a Kit

### The Complete Kit Contents

Every Table Patterns kit should contain these elements. Nothing more, nothing less. Do not over-pack: customers get overwhelmed. Do not under-pack: missing a component creates a bad experience and a return.

## Kit Contents Checklist

- ☐ **Pattern sheet:** Printed on cardstock or heavy paper. Full size — not reduced. Number every row. Include a finished-size reference at the top.
- ☐ **Pre-cut fabric:** Cut to the exact dimensions the crafter will need, plus a 1-inch margin on all sides for error. Press the fabric flat before packing. Label it (e.g., “Main fabric — 14 × 48 inches”).
- ☐ **Pre-measured cord or thread:** Measured and cut to length. Add 10% extra to every length — the customer may use slightly more than you do. Bundle each color separately with a small label (e.g., “Natural cord — 3 lengths of 72 inches”).
- ☐ **Written instructions:** A simplified, beginner-friendly version of your own process. Use numbered steps, not paragraphs. Include a drawing or diagram for any step that is hard to describe in words. End with “Finishing: trim all loose ends and press flat.”
- ☐ **Difficulty tag:** A small card or sticker that says “Beginner,” “Intermediate,” or “Advanced.” Customers appreciate knowing what they are getting into.
- ☐ **Tool list card:** A card listing what tools the customer needs that are NOT included (scissors, ruler, pins, glue gun if applicable). Keep this list short — common household items only.



### What NOT to include

Do not include tools (scissors, rulers, pins) in the kit. They add cost and weight, and most crafters already own them. If a specialized tool is required (a specific needle, a particular glue), mention it prominently on the package and in the listing so the customer knows to buy it separately before starting.

## Writing the Instruction Card

Your instruction card is the most important part of the kit. A customer who gets stuck will not buy from you again. Follow these rules:

- **Number every step.** “Step 7: Fold the cord under the third row and pull through” is clearer than “Next, fold the cord under and pull through.”
- **Use the same vocabulary throughout.** If you call it “cord” in step 1, do not switch to “string” in step 5.
- **State dimensions in both inches and centimeters.** Your customers may think in either system.
- **Include at least one checkpoint.** After step 6 (or wherever the halfway point falls), include: “Checkpoint: your piece should now measure approximately X inches wide. If it is narrower, your tension is too tight. If wider, too loose. Adjust on the next row.”
- **End with care instructions.** How to wash, how to store, whether to iron.

## Pricing Your Kits

### The Kit Cost Breakdown

Knowing your exact cost per kit is essential. Use this table to calculate yours:

| COST COMPONENT                               | PLACEMAT KIT<br>EXAMPLE | RUNNER KIT<br>EXAMPLE | CENTERPIECE KIT<br>EXAMPLE |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| Fabric                                       | \$1.80                  | \$3.50                | \$2.20                     |
| Cord / thread                                | \$1.50                  | \$3.00                | \$2.00                     |
| Printed pattern + instructions               | \$0.60                  | \$0.80                | \$0.60                     |
| Packaging (bag, label, card)                 | \$0.50                  | \$0.70                | \$0.50                     |
| <b>Total materials cost</b>                  | <b>\$4.40</b>           | <b>\$8.00</b>         | <b>\$5.30</b>              |
| Assembly time (your labor)                   | 15 min                  | 20 min                | 15 min                     |
| <b>Retail price (materials ×<br/>2.5–3×)</b> | <b>\$11 – \$13</b>      | <b>\$20 – \$24</b>    | <b>\$13 – \$16</b>         |

## Finished Piece vs. Kit: Profit Per Hour

| PRODUCT           | SELL PRICE | MATERIAL COST | YOUR TIME | PROFIT | PROFIT PER HOUR |
|-------------------|------------|---------------|-----------|--------|-----------------|
| Finished placemat | \$35       | \$6           | 2.5 hours | \$29   | \$11.60/hr      |
| Placemat kit      | \$12       | \$4.40        | 15 min    | \$7.60 | \$30.40/hr      |
| Finished runner   | \$65       | \$11          | 5 hours   | \$54   | \$10.80/hr      |
| Runner kit        | \$22       | \$8.00        | 20 min    | \$14   | \$42.00/hr      |

### Kits are not a discount — they are a different product

Do not think of a kit as a “cheap version” of your finished piece. It is an entirely different product for a different customer. The finished-piece buyer values your craftsmanship. The kit buyer values the experience of making it. You serve both — and the kit earns you more per hour.



*Buying materials in bulk cuts your per-kit cost and keeps production moving without delays.*

### Bulk Material Buying Tips

- **Buy fabric in bolts, not by the yard.** Fabric stores often discount full bolts by 20–40%. If a bolt is more than you need, split it with another local crafter.

- **Order cord in 100-meter or 200-meter spools.** The per-meter cost drops significantly. Store extra in sealed bags away from moisture.
- **Print instructions in batches of 50+.** Local print shops give volume discounts, or invest in a decent home printer and buy cardstock in bulk.
- **Buy packaging materials online in quantities of 100+.** Kraft bags, clear poly bags, and cardstock labels are all cheaper in bulk from packaging suppliers than from craft stores.



*Finished kits staged and ready to ship -- professional packaging builds buyer confidence.*

## Packaging and Presentation

*How your kit looks when the customer opens it determines whether they trust your instructions, enjoy the process, and come back for another kit. Presentation is not decoration — it is communication.*

### Packaging Materials You Need

| MATERIAL                                               | PURPOSE                                                        | APPROX. COST<br>(PER KIT) |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Kraft paper bag or clear poly bag<br>(9×12" or 11×14") | Main container. Kraft looks premium; clear shows the contents. | \$0.15 – \$0.30           |

| MATERIAL                   | PURPOSE                                                      | APPROX. COST<br>(PER KIT) |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Cardstock label (4×6")     | Front label with kit name, contents, difficulty level.       | \$0.10 – \$0.20           |
| Small ziplock bags (3×4")  | Separate cord bundles by color to prevent tangling.          | \$0.03 per bag            |
| Tissue paper (1 sheet)     | Wrap the fabric to keep it clean and add an unboxing moment. | \$0.05                    |
| Washi tape or sticker seal | Close the bag neatly. Adds a small branding touch.           | \$0.05                    |

## Packing Order (prevents tangling and confusion)

- 1 Instruction card on top.** This is the first thing the customer sees when they open the bag. It immediately tells them what they are looking at and that everything is organized.
- 2 Pattern sheet behind the instructions.** Fold it neatly to fit the bag, pattern side facing out.
- 3 Fabric, wrapped in tissue paper.** Fold the fabric to fit the bag without bunching. The tissue keeps it clean and creates a satisfying unwrapping experience.
- 4 Cord/thread in labeled ziplock bags at the bottom.** Each color or type of cord gets its own small bag with a tiny label (a piece of masking tape with the color name or number written on it works fine). This prevents tangling and makes it easy for the customer to grab the right cord at each step.
- 5 Difficulty tag and tool list card tucked into the side.** These are reference cards the customer will pull out and set next to their workspace.

### Standard Packaging

Kraft bag, printed label, tissue paper wrap, labeled ziplock bags for cord. Clean, professional, and affordable. Best for online sales and craft fair sales.

**Cost per kit:** \$0.30 – \$0.50

**Best for:** Everyday sales, Etsy, craft fairs

### Gift-Ready Packaging

Clear bag (so the contents are visible), tied with a ribbon, small gift tag attached. The customer can give it as-is without re-wrapping. Charge \$2–3 more for this option.

**Cost per kit:** \$0.60 – \$0.90

**Best for:** Holiday sales, "gift for a crafter" positioning

## The Instruction Card Layout

Your instruction card should be a single sheet of cardstock (printed both sides) or a folded card. Here is the layout:

### FRONT OF CARD

- Kit name (e.g., "Herringbone Table Runner Kit")
- Difficulty level: Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced
- Finished size (e.g., "14 × 72 inches")
- Estimated time to complete (e.g., "4–6 hours")
- Contents list (what is in the bag)
- Tools you will need (what is NOT in the bag)

### BACK OF CARD (OR INSIDE OF FOLD)

- Numbered steps, 1 through however many
- At least one checkpoint with measurements
- Finishing instructions
- Care instructions for the completed piece



*A dedicated shipping station streamlines fulfillment and keeps orders moving out the door.*

# Selling and Shipping Kits

## Where to Sell

### ONLINE CHANNELS

- **Etsy.** The natural fit. List kits alongside your finished pieces. Use the "Craft Supplies & Tools" category. Include clear photos of the kit contents laid out flat, plus a photo of the finished piece. In the description, emphasize what is included and the skill level required.
- **Facebook Marketplace and craft groups.** Post in local and niche craft groups. Kits ship well, so you can sell outside your immediate area. Group rules vary — check before posting.
- **Your own website or landing page.** If you have one, add a "Kits" section. If you do not, kits are a good reason to create a simple one-page shop.

### LOCAL CHANNELS

- **Craft fairs and markets.** Display the finished piece prominently, then set the kit next to it. Many browsers who cannot afford the finished piece will buy the kit. This captures sales you would otherwise lose.
- **Consignment at local shops.** Gift shops, craft stores, and boutiques may carry your kits on a 60/40 split (you keep 60%). Approach the owner with a sample kit and the finished piece. Offer to stock 5 kits on trial.
- **Workshops.** Sell kits at the end of every workshop. Participants who just made one piece under your guidance are the most motivated kit buyers you will ever find.

## Shipping Kits

| KIT TYPE        | TYPICAL WEIGHT | BEST SHIPPING METHOD                                  | APPROXIMATE COST (US DOMESTIC) |
|-----------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Placemat kit    | 6–10 oz        | USPS First Class Package or padded flat rate envelope | \$4.00 – \$5.50                |
| Runner kit      | 12–18 oz       | USPS Priority Mail small flat rate box                | \$8.00 – \$10.00               |
| Centerpiece kit | 8–14 oz        | USPS First Class Package or padded flat rate envelope | \$5.00 – \$7.00                |

**Packing for shipping:** Place the kit bag inside a slightly larger poly mailer or padded envelope. Add a piece of cardboard if the pattern sheet should not be bent. Seal securely. Include a thank-you card with a note encouraging the customer to share a photo of their finished piece.

## Handling Kit Returns

Kits have lower return rates than finished pieces because the customer made a deliberate choice to buy a project. However, returns do happen. Handle them this way:

- **Unopened kit (packaging intact):** Accept the return. Refund minus original shipping cost. Restock the kit.
- **Opened kit (contents removed):** If the materials are unused and undamaged, accept the return. Repack and restock. If materials have been cut or used, offer a partial refund or store credit. Do not argue — it costs you more in time and reputation than the refund costs in money.
- **“I do not understand the instructions”:** This is not a return request; it is a customer service moment. Send a brief clarification. If the same step confuses multiple people, rewrite that part of your instructions.

## Encouraging Customer Photos

Photos of customers' finished kit pieces are your best marketing. They prove the kit works and build social proof. Here is how to get them:

- Include a small card in every kit: “Finished your piece? We would love to see it! Share a photo with #TablePatternsKit.”
- Follow up with a message 2–3 weeks after purchase (Etsy lets you message buyers): “How is your project going? If you have finished it, we would love to see a photo!”
- Feature customer photos in your listings (with their permission). “Made by a customer from our kit” is powerful social proof.

## Seasonal Kit Collections

Tie your kit releases to the same seasonal calendar you use for finished pieces. Refer back to the Repeat Buyer Blueprint for timing. Some natural kit seasons:

| SEASON / EVENT              | KIT THEME                                                             | LAUNCH TIMING                |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Spring / Easter             | Pastel palette placemat kit, spring runner with floral border         | List by early March          |
| Summer                      | Outdoor entertaining set (jute or natural cord), nautical-themed kit  | List by mid-May              |
| Fall / Thanksgiving         | Harvest colors runner kit, Thanksgiving centerpiece kit               | List by late August          |
| Winter / Christmas          | Holiday table set kit (runner + 4 placemats), gift-ready beginner kit | List by early October        |
| Mother's Day / Father's Day | “Craft with Mom/Dad” beginner kit positioned as a gift                | 4–5 weeks before the holiday |

## SECTION 4

# Workshop-in-a-Box

Everything you need to teach your first workshop: format options, a word-for-word script, cost calculations, and a booking playbook.

*A single 2-hour workshop with 8 participants at \$45 each earns you \$360 — minus about \$64 in materials, that is \$296 for an afternoon. No shipping, no waiting for sales, no inventory management. Workshops also turn participants into lifelong customers of your finished pieces and kits. Here is exactly how to plan, price, and deliver one.*



*Each workstation set up before participants arrive -- preparation is half the teaching.*

# Your Workshop Format

## Three Formats to Choose From

| FORMAT                    | DURATION                       | GROUP SIZE | SKILL LEVEL              | WHAT THEY TAKE HOME                 | PRICE RANGE   |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------|------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Intro Workshop</b>     | 2 hours                        | 6 – 12     | Complete beginner        | One placemat or small mat           | \$35 – \$55   |
| <b>Half-Day Workshop</b>  | 4 hours                        | 6 – 10     | Beginner to intermediate | One placemat plus start on a runner | \$65 – \$95   |
| <b>Full-Day Immersive</b> | 6 – 7 hours (with lunch break) | 4 – 8      | Intermediate             | One complete runner or centerpiece  | \$120 – \$175 |

### Start with the 2-hour Intro

If you have never taught before, start with the Intro format. It is the least intimidating for you and your participants, the lowest material cost, and the easiest to fill. Once you have done 3–4 Intro workshops and feel comfortable, try a Half-Day.

## Choosing a Project for Your Workshop

Pick a project that meets all four of these criteria:

1. **Completable in the allotted time** — participants must leave with a finished (or nearly finished) piece. Nothing kills enthusiasm faster than an unfinished project.
2. **Visually impressive relative to the effort** — the finished piece should look like something the participant would proudly put on their table. Simple does not have to mean plain.
3. **Forgiving of mistakes** — beginners will make errors. Choose patterns where a small mistake is barely noticeable, not ones where every row must be perfect.
4. **Uses materials that are easy to handle** — thick cord and sturdy fabric are easier for beginners than fine thread and delicate fabric. Save the delicate work for advanced classes.

## The Workshop Script

*This is a complete, ready-to-use script for a 2-hour beginner workshop. The words in quotation marks are exactly what you say. Adapt the project details to your specific pattern, but keep the structure and transitions — they are designed to maintain energy and momentum throughout.*

### Welcome and Introductions (10 minutes)

*Participants are arriving, finding seats, settling in. Each place is already set up with materials.*

“Welcome, everyone! I am so glad you are here. My name is [your first name], and I have been making table runners, placemats, and centerpieces from cord and fabric for [X years]. Today, you are going to make your very own [name of project — e.g., “Herringbone Placemat”] — and you are going to take it home with you.”

“Before we start, I want to set your expectations: nobody in this room needs to be ‘crafty.’ If you can tie a knot and count to five, you have every skill you need. I am going to walk you through every single step. If you get stuck, raise your hand and I will come right over. There is no such thing as a dumb question here.”

“Let us go around the room quickly — just your first name and one sentence about why you signed up. I will start: I signed up because I love watching people discover that they can make something beautiful with their hands.”

*Go around the room. Keep it to one sentence each. If someone starts telling a long story, gently redirect: “I love that — we will have time to chat more during the break.”*

## **Materials Overview and Pattern Selection (15 minutes)**

“Let us look at what is in front of you. You each have [list the materials]. Take a moment to touch everything — feel the cord, feel the fabric. This is [type of cord] — it is great for beginners because it is thick enough to see clearly and forgiving enough that you can undo a mistake and redo it.”

“Now, pick up your pattern sheet. This is the map for your placemat. Each row is numbered. We are going to work through it row by row, together. Do not look ahead — just follow along with me.”

*Hold up a finished example of the project.*

“This is what yours will look like when we are done. Notice the [describe 1–2 key features: the diagonal pattern, the border, the fringe]. You are going to make all of that today.”

*If you are offering a color choice:* “You will see that you have [two/three] color options for your cord. Take a minute to pick the one that appeals to you. There is no wrong answer — they all look great.”

## **Demonstration: Basic Technique (20 minutes)**

“Okay, put your materials to one side for just a moment. I am going to demonstrate the basic technique we will use for the entire piece. Watch first, then we will do it together.”

*Position yourself so everyone can see. If the group is large, move to the center or use a phone camera connected to a screen. Do the first 3–4 rows slowly, narrating every move.*

“I am starting with my fabric laid flat, smooth side up. I am placing my first cord across the top edge, leaving about an inch hanging off each side — we will trim that later.”

“Now I am going to [describe your specific technique — weaving, knotting, wrapping, etc.]. Watch how I hold the cord with my left hand and guide it with my right. See how I keep the tension even? Not too tight, not too loose. If I pull too hard, the fabric bunches. If I leave it too loose, the cord will shift later.”

“That is one row. Now I move down [the distance] and repeat. Count with me: one, two, three, four, five — that is where my next row goes.”

*Do 2–3 more rows, continuing to narrate.*

“Questions so far? Do not worry if it looked fast — when you do it yourself in a moment, you will go at your own pace.”

## **Guided Practice: First Section (30 minutes)**

“Now it is your turn. Pick up your fabric and your first cord. Lay the fabric flat. I am going to walk you through the first three rows step by step. Do not move ahead until I say.”

“Step one: place your cord across the top edge, an inch of extra cord hanging off each side. Everyone, hold it up and show me. Great — everyone is in the right spot.”

*Move around the room. Check everyone's placement. Fix any issues gently and with specific language: “Slide it a half inch to the left — there you go.”*

“Step two: [describe the technique step]. Everyone do this now. Take your time. I am coming around.”

*Continue through the first 3 rows this way — you say the step, everyone does it, you check. After 3 rows:*

“Excellent. You have just completed the first three rows. Look at what you have already made! Now, for the next few rows, I want you to work at your own pace. Follow your pattern sheet. I am going to walk around and help anyone who needs it. Raise your hand if you get stuck.”

*Circulate for the remaining time. Help individuals one-on-one. Watch for the most common mistakes and correct them early.*

## **Break (10 minutes)**

“Okay, everyone, let us take a 10-minute break. Stand up, stretch, grab a drink if you brought one. Do not worry about your piece — it will be right here when you get back. We are right on track.”

*During the break, quickly scan everyone's work. Note anyone who is falling behind or struggling. When you resume, give those participants extra attention.*

## **Independent Work with Guidance (25 minutes)**

“Welcome back! You are doing beautifully. For this next stretch, you are going to work through the rest of the pattern at your own pace. I am here the whole time — raise your hand whenever you need me.”

“A few tips before you dive back in: First, check your tension every few rows. Is it the same as the first rows? If it is getting tighter, you are probably tensing up — take a breath and relax your hands. Second, if you make a mistake, stop. Do not try to fix it by going forward — undo back to the mistake and redo it. It is faster in the long run and the result looks much better.”

*Circulate continuously. Prioritize participants who are struggling. Offer encouragement to everyone: “That tension is looking really consistent — nice work.” If someone finishes early, show them a finishing technique or let them start experimenting with a variation.*

## **Finishing and Photo Time (10 minutes)**

“Okay, everyone! We are in the final stretch. Let me show you how to finish the edges. [Demonstrate your finishing technique — trimming, knotting, tucking, etc.] Take your time with this part. The finish is what people notice first.”

*Help participants finish their pieces.*

“Look at what you made! Hold it up. Every single one of these is unique — your tension, your color choice, the little things that make it yours. I want to take a group photo if everyone is willing — hold your pieces up!”

*Take a group photo plus individual close-ups of each piece (with permission). These are your marketing materials for future workshops.*

“Thank you all for coming today. You should be genuinely proud of what you made. If you want to keep going and make more pieces at home, I have kits available right here [gesture to your kit display]. Each kit has everything you need — fabric, cord, pattern, and instructions — to make another piece at home.”

“Your next step: take your placemat home, put it on your table, and enjoy it. And if you make more pieces using a kit, I would love to see photos.”

# Supply List and Costs

## Per-Student Materials

| ITEM                                       | QUANTITY PER STUDENT | COST PER STUDENT   |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Pre-cut fabric (placemat size)             | 1 piece              | \$1.80             |
| Cord/thread (pre-measured, with 10% extra) | 1 bundle             | \$2.00             |
| Printed pattern sheet                      | 1 sheet              | \$0.40             |
| Pins (small handful, reusable)             | 6–8 pins             | \$0.20 (amortized) |
| Extra cord for mistakes                    | 15% buffer           | \$0.30             |
| Take-home care card                        | 1 card               | \$0.10             |
| Bag for finished piece                     | 1 bag                | \$0.15             |
| Total per student                          |                      | \$4.95             |

## Your Toolkit (Bring to Every Workshop)

### Workshop Toolkit

- ☐ 2 pairs of sharp fabric scissors (one for you, one to lend)
- ☐ Measuring tape and ruler
- ☐ Glue gun and glue sticks (if your technique uses them)
- ☐ Extra pins (participants lose them)
- ☐ Extra cord in each color (for mistakes)
- ☐ 3 finished example pieces (to show at the start and display during the session)
- ☐ A phone or camera for photos
- ☐ Name tags and markers (for introductions)
- ☐ Your pattern sheets (3 extra copies in case someone damages theirs)
- ☐ A small tablecloth or mat for your demonstration area
- ☐ Kits for sale at the end (bring at least as many as there are participants)

### Room Requirements

- A table or desk space per participant (at least 24 × 36 inches of surface area each)
- Good overhead lighting — crafting in dim light is miserable
- A power outlet nearby if you use a glue gun
- A clear surface where you can demonstrate for the whole group to see
- Parking or easy public transit access (participants will not come if it is hard to get there)

### Cost Per Student at Different Group Sizes

| GROUP SIZE | MATERIAL COST TOTAL | VENUE FEE (IF ANY) | TOTAL COST  | REVENUE AT \$45/PERSON | YOUR PROFIT   |
|------------|---------------------|--------------------|-------------|------------------------|---------------|
| 4 students | \$20                | \$0 – \$50         | \$20 – \$70 | \$180                  | \$110 – \$160 |
| 6 students | \$30                | \$0 – \$50         | \$30 – \$80 | \$270                  | \$190 – \$240 |

| GROUP SIZE  | MATERIAL COST TOTAL | VENUE FEE (IF ANY) | TOTAL COST   | REVENUE AT \$45/PERSON | YOUR PROFIT   |
|-------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------|------------------------|---------------|
| 8 students  | \$40                | \$0 – \$50         | \$40 – \$90  | \$360                  | \$270 – \$320 |
| 10 students | \$50                | \$0 – \$75         | \$50 – \$125 | \$450                  | \$325 – \$400 |
| 12 students | \$60                | \$0 – \$75         | \$60 – \$135 | \$540                  | \$405 – \$480 |

### Break-even point

At \$45 per student and ~\$5 in materials per student, your break-even is 2 students if the venue is free, or 3–4 students if you are paying a room fee of \$25–\$50. Every student beyond break-even is nearly pure profit (minus ~\$5 in materials). This is why 8+ students is the sweet spot.

## Pitching and Booking

*The hardest part of doing workshops is not the teaching — it is getting the first one booked. This section gives you the exact words to use and a step-by-step process for going from “idea” to “confirmed date.”*

### Where to Host

| VENUE TYPE                               | TYPICAL COST                                   | PROS                                                                                    | CONS                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Community centers</b>                 | \$0 – \$50/session                             | Often have tables and chairs set up. May advertise your workshop in their newsletter.   | May require insurance. Booking can be slow.                                                 |
| <b>Public libraries</b>                  | Usually free                                   | Built-in audience. Libraries often handle registration for you.                         | May limit what you can sell. Expect smaller groups.                                         |
| <b>Craft or yarn stores</b>              | \$0 (revenue share or you buy materials there) | Audience is pre-qualified (they are already crafters). The store may promote the event. | Space may be limited. The store will expect you to recommend their products.                |
| <b>Private homes (yours or a host's)</b> | \$0                                            | No venue cost. Intimate setting. You control the environment.                           | Liability concerns. Group size limited by your space. Need to handle registration yourself. |

| VENUE TYPE          | TYPICAL COST | PROS                                                                            | CONS                                                                          |
|---------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Online (video call) | \$0          | No geographic limit. Participants join from anywhere. You ship kits in advance. | Harder to help individuals. Need good camera setup. Less personal connection. |



*An online workshop setup with overhead camera lets remote participants follow every step.*

**The Venue Pitch**

Here is exactly what to say when you approach a venue manager. Adapt the details but keep the structure — it covers everything they need to hear:

## The Pitch Script

"Hi, my name is [your name]. I make handmade table runners, placemats, and centerpieces from fabric and cord, and I teach people how to make them. I would love to host a 2-hour beginner workshop here at [venue name].

Here is how it works: I bring all the materials. Each participant makes a complete placemat during the session and takes it home. I handle registration and payment. All I need from you is a room with tables and chairs for 8–12 people, and good lighting.

I charge \$45 per participant. I am happy to [choose one: pay a small room fee / give you a percentage of registrations / promote [venue name] in my event listing / purchase materials from your store].

I have done workshops before and participants love them. Would you be open to doing a trial event? I am flexible on dates — evenings and weekends work best for participants."

*If the venue asks for more details, provide:*

- A photo of a finished workshop piece
- A list of the materials you will bring (so they know you are not leaving a mess)
- Your plan for cleanup (you clean your area and leave it as you found it)
- References from previous workshop participants, if you have them

## The Booking Process

- 1 **Make a list of 5 potential venues** in your area. Mix types: one community center, one library, one craft store, one local business with event space, one friend's home as a backup.
- 2 **Contact each one** using the pitch script above. In person is best for local shops. Phone or email works for community centers and libraries. Give them a week to respond before following up.
- 3 **Confirm the date, time, and room** in writing (email is fine). Ask about: table count, lighting, parking, whether you can display kits for sale, whether they need proof of insurance.
- 4 **Create a simple sign-up method.** A shared spreadsheet with columns for Name, Email, Number of Spots, and Payment Status works perfectly. If the venue handles registration, coordinate with them on capacity and payment.
- 5 **Promote the workshop.** Post in local Facebook groups, on community bulletin boards, and in your existing customer network. Give people at least 2–3 weeks of notice. Include: date, time, location, what they will make, what they take home, price, and how to sign up.

- 6 **Confirm with registered participants** 3 days before the workshop. Send a brief message: “Looking forward to seeing you on [date]! Here is the address: [address]. Please arrive 5 minutes early so we can start on time. No need to bring anything — all materials are included.”
- 7 **Prep your materials** 2 days before. Cut all fabric, measure all cord, print all patterns. Pack everything per student (one bag per student with all their materials). This prep should take about 30–45 minutes per student.
- 8 **Day of: arrive 30 minutes early.** Set up each workstation with a materials bag, a pattern sheet, and a finished example piece at the front of the room. Test your lighting. Lay out your kits for sale in a visible spot.

## Pricing Your Workshop

The formula:

**$(\text{Material cost per student} \times 1.5) + (\text{Your hourly rate} \times \text{total hours including prep}) \div \text{expected group size} = \text{minimum price per student}.$**

Example: Materials are \$5 per student. Your target hourly rate is \$40/hour. Total time is 5 hours (2 teaching + 3 prep/travel). Expected group size is 8.

$(\$5 \times 1.5) + (\$40 \times 5) \div 8 = \$7.50 + \$25 = \text{\$32.50 minimum per student}.$

Round up and add a margin: **\$45 per student** is a strong price for a 2-hour intro workshop. It covers your costs, pays you well, and remains affordable for most participants.

## Converting Workshop Students to Repeat Customers

- **Sell kits at the end.** This is the highest-conversion moment. They just made something; they want to make more. Have kits ready, displayed beautifully, at different difficulty levels.
- **Offer a “next level” workshop.** At the end of a beginner workshop, mention that you offer a half-day or full-day workshop for people who want to tackle a bigger project. Collect names of interested participants.
- **Collect permission to follow up.** At registration, include: “Would you like to hear about future workshops and new patterns?” A simple yes/no checkbox. Only follow up with people who said yes.
- **Share the group photo.** After the workshop, share the group photo with participants and encourage them to share it. Every shared photo is free marketing for your next workshop.

## SECTION 5

# 10 Professional Label Templates

Ready-to-print label designs for your products, kits, workshops, and customer communications.

*Professional labels make the difference between a hobby and a business. These 10 templates cover every labeling need you will encounter — from product tags to workshop signs. Each one is described in full detail with exact dimensions, layout, and content fields so you can create them using any word processor, design tool, or even by hand.*



*Professional labels turn a handmade piece into a branded product.*

## How to Use These Templates

- Print on cardstock (80 lb / 216 gsm minimum) for durability unless noted otherwise.
- Cut along the outer dimensions using a paper trimmer for clean edges. Scissors work but a trimmer gives you a professional look.
- Fields in [brackets] are placeholders — replace them with your specific information.
- All templates use a clean, minimal design: one accent color, clear typography, generous white space.

## Label 1: Product Hang Tag

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Attach to finished pieces for sale at craft fairs, in stores, or for online orders.                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Dimensions    | 2" × 3.5" (standard business card size, vertical orientation)                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Hole punch    | 1/8" hole centered, 1/4" from top edge. Thread with jute twine or ribbon to attach to piece.                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Front layout  | Top: [Your Brand Name] in serif font, 14pt, centered. Middle: [Piece Name] in sans-serif, 11pt (e.g., "Herringbone Table Runner"). Below that: [Material] in light italic, 9pt (e.g., "Cotton cord on linen"). Bottom: [Size] in 9pt (e.g., "14 × 72 inches"). |
| Back layout   | Top: "Care Instructions" in 8pt bold. Below: 3–4 lines of care text in 7.5pt (e.g., "Spot clean with damp cloth. Lay flat to dry. Iron on low if needed. Store rolled, not folded."). Bottom: "Handmade with care" in italic, 8pt.                             |
| Print         | Cardstock, double-sided. Use your accent color for the brand name.                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Label 2: Care Instruction Card

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Include with every finished piece and every kit. Tells the customer how to maintain their piece.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Dimensions    | 3" × 4" (vertical orientation)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Front layout  | Top: [Your Brand Name], 12pt, centered. Rule line below. Heading: "Care for Your [Piece Type]" in 10pt bold. Body (9pt, left-aligned): <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Spot clean gently with a damp cloth and mild soap.</li><li>• For full cleaning, hand wash in cool water. Do not wring.</li><li>• Lay flat on a clean towel to dry. Do not hang — the weight stretches the cord.</li><li>• Iron on low heat if wrinkled. Place a thin cloth between the iron and the piece.</li><li>• Store rolled (not folded) in a cool, dry place.</li><li>• Keep away from direct sunlight to prevent fading.</li></ul> |
| Back layout   | Blank, or repeat your brand name in light watermark style.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Print         | Cardstock, single-sided. Neutral background (cream or white).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Label 3: Craft Kit Label (Front of Package)

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                 |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | The main label on the front of your craft kit packaging. What the customer sees first. |
| Dimensions    | 4" × 6" (vertical orientation)                                                         |

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Layout        | Top band (1" tall, accent color background): [Your Brand Name] in white, 14pt, centered. Below band: [Kit Name] in 16pt serif bold (e.g., "Braided Placemat Kit"). Difficulty badge: round or pill-shaped badge showing "Beginner" / "Intermediate" / "Advanced" in 8pt. Finished size: "Makes one [piece] — [dimensions]" in 9pt. Contents list: bulleted, 8.5pt ("Pre-cut cotton fabric," "Natural jute cord (3 lengths)," "Printed pattern and instructions," "Difficulty: [level]"). Bottom: "You will also need: scissors, ruler, pins" in italic, 8pt. |
| Print         | Cardstock, single-sided. Attach to front of bag with tape or slip into clear bag facing out.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

### Label 4: Kit Instruction Header

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Printed at the top of your instruction sheet inside the kit. Brands the instructions.                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Dimensions    | 5" × 2" (horizontal strip, top of page)                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Layout        | Left side: [Your Brand Name] in 14pt serif. Right side: "Pattern Instructions" in 10pt. Below, spanning full width: thin rule line. Below line: [Kit Name] in 11pt bold, then "Finished size: [dimensions]   Difficulty: [level]   Estimated time: [hours]" in 8.5pt. |
| Print         | Printed as part of the full instruction sheet. Regular paper or cardstock.                                                                                                                                                                                            |

### Label 5: Workshop Sign-Up Sheet Header

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Top of a printed sign-up sheet at craft fairs, events, or at the venue where you want to collect interest for future workshops.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Dimensions    | 8.5" × 2" (full width of letter paper, top section)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Layout        | Left: [Your Brand Name] in 16pt serif, bold. Right: "Workshop Sign-Up" in 12pt. Below, full width: "Learn to make your own handmade table pieces! Beginner-friendly, all materials included. Sign up below to hear about upcoming dates and locations." in 10pt. Below text: rule line. Then column headers for the sign-up table: Name   Email   Preferred Day (Weekday / Weekend)   Notes. |
| Print         | Regular paper, single-sided. Print header, then rule lines below for 15–20 rows.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Label 6: Price Tag (Craft Fair)

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Small price tag displayed next to or on each piece at a craft fair or market.                                                                                                                                    |
| Dimensions    | 1.5" × 2.5" (vertical, tent-fold optional so it stands up)                                                                                                                                                       |
| Layout        | Top: [Piece Name] in 9pt bold (e.g., "Diamond Runner"). Middle: [\$Price] in 18pt serif, bold, accent color (e.g., "\$55"). Bottom: [Size] and [Material] in 7.5pt italic (e.g., "14×72 in. — Cotton on linen"). |
| Print         | Cardstock. Print multiple on one sheet (fit 8–10 per letter-size page) and cut apart. Optional: fold in half vertically to create a small tent card that stands on its own.                                      |

## Label 7: Thank You / Reorder Card

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Insert with every delivery. Encourages repeat orders and photo sharing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Dimensions    | 4" × 6" (horizontal orientation, postcard style)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Front layout  | Centered, generous margins: "Thank You" in 22pt serif. Below: "Your [piece name] was handmade with care. We hope it brings warmth and beauty to your table for years to come." in 11pt. Bottom: [Your Brand Name] in 10pt.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Back layout   | Top half: "Love your piece? Here is your next step:" in 10pt bold. Below: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• "Share a photo of your table setting — we would love to see it! Use #TablePatternsHome."</li><li>• "Looking for a matching set? Browse our collection for coordinating runners, placemats, and centerpieces."</li><li>• "Try making your own! Our craft kits include everything you need."</li></ul> All in 9pt. Bottom: "Thank you for supporting handmade." in italic, 9pt. |
| Print         | Cardstock, double-sided.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## Label 8: Collection Label (Seasonal Sets)

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Label for seasonal or themed collections (e.g., "Autumn Harvest Collection"). Attach to bundled sets or use as a display sign. |
| Dimensions    | 3" × 4" (vertical orientation)                                                                                                 |

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Layout        | Top: [Your Brand Name] in 10pt. Center: [Collection Name] in 16pt serif, bold (e.g., “Autumn Harvest”). Below: [Season/Year] in 9pt italic (e.g., “Fall 2026”). Below: “This collection includes:” in 9pt bold. List of pieces in 8.5pt (e.g., • 1 Table Runner (14×72 in.) • 4 Placemats (14×18 in.) • 1 Centerpiece Mat (12×12 in.)). Bottom: [Set Price] in 14pt bold, accent color. Below price: “Save [amount] vs. buying separately” in 8pt italic. |
| Print         | Cardstock, single-sided. Use a seasonal accent color for the collection name.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

### Label 9: Custom Order Confirmation Card

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Include with a custom-order delivery. Confirms the specifications and personalizes the experience.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Dimensions    | 4" × 6" (horizontal orientation)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Layout        | Top: [Your Brand Name] in 12pt serif. Right of brand: “Custom Order” in 10pt pill badge. Rule line. Body (10pt): “Made for: [Customer First Name]” in bold. “Pattern: [Pattern Name]”. “Colors: [Color 1], [Color 2]”. “Size: [Dimensions]”. “Completed: [Date]”. Rule line. Bottom: “This piece was made by hand, just for you. Every knot, every row, every detail was crafted with intention. We hope you love it.” in 9pt italic. |
| Print         | Cardstock, single-sided. Fill in the fields by hand in pen for a personal touch, or print with fields pre-filled.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

### Label 10: Gift Tag

| SPECIFICATION | DETAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use case      | Attach to gift-wrapped pieces or gift-ready kits. The buyer fills in the recipient’s name.                                                                                                                      |
| Dimensions    | 2" × 2" (square)                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Hole punch    | 1/8" hole in top-left corner. Tie with ribbon or twine.                                                                                                                                                         |
| Front layout  | Top: “Handmade for you” in 9pt serif italic. Center: large blank space for the buyer to write the recipient’s name. Bottom: a small decorative rule or simple motif (a single line, a small knot illustration). |
| Back layout   | “From:” with a blank line. Below: [Your Brand Name] in 7pt. Below: “Handmade table pieces and craft kits” in 7pt italic.                                                                                        |
| Print         | Cardstock, double-sided. Print 9–12 per letter-size page. Cut with a paper trimmer. Round the corners with a corner punch for a polished look.                                                                  |

### Printing tip

To save money, lay out multiple labels on a single page before printing. Most word processors let you create a table with cells sized to your label dimensions, remove the cell borders, and print multiple labels per sheet. For the 2"x2" gift tags, you can fit 12 on a letter-size page. For 4"x6" cards, you get 2 per page.



*From solo maker to a team that shares your craft -- this is what scaling your studio looks like.*

## Next Step

Pick one path from the Blueprint.

**If you chose kits,** assemble your first one this week using the Craft Kit Assembly Guide. Start with your simplest pattern — cut the fabric, measure the cord, write the instructions, pack the bag. List it and see what happens.

**If you chose a helper,** start looking this week using the Finding Your Helper section. Make your list of places to post, write your message, and post it in three places before the week is out.

**If you chose workshops,** read the Workshop Script all the way through, then make a list of five potential venues. Contact the first one this week. All you need is a confirmed date to set everything else in motion.

*You have the patterns. You have the skill. Now you have the system to grow beyond your own two hands. The only thing left is to start.*

## Table Patterns